The Noble Dhāraṇī of Vajrabhairava

Āryavajrabhairavadhāraṇīnāma · Toh 956 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་རྡོར་འཇིགས་བྱེད་ཀྱི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of Noble Vajrabhairava, whose Sanskrit title appears as Āryavajrabhairavadhāraṇīnāma, is a short incantatory text that opens with homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas and a prayer that the victorious ones and their heirs grant the supreme and boundless sublime. Its core is a single dhāraṇī, presented as "vajra words" and called the heart of all vidyā-mantras and secret mantras. The text then explains the benefits of reciting this formula a thousand times in the presence of a representation of the Tathāgata. It is Toh 956 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of spells and protective formulas preserved in the Tibetan canon.

In the language of India: ārya bajra bhairapa dhāraṇī nāma

In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of Noble Vajrabhairava

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

May the Victors together with their heirs, who are stainless, who dispel stains, who are infinite and boundless, who grant the sublime and are exceedingly vast, all be in harmony with me and always bestow the supreme of the infinite sublime.

Of that, my vajra words are these:

arara asama samatā anantadharmatre khaṇākhaṇā mahābire cales mama āsahā mahābale kaṇakaṇa mahābala āgrihe haha bajra bajrāhāye dhara dhara hūṃ hūṃ maṇḍala samapara akra bikrame kuru kuru turu turu sarbaṃ thā sarba hi jvala jvala akrini phaṭ svāhā

If one recites this heart of all vidyā-mantras and secret mantras a thousand times in the presence of the Tathāgata, it will be as though one had recited all vidyā-mantras and secret mantras a hundred thousand times. It also makes all other rites effective and unobstructed, for among all the vidyā-mantras, secret mantras, heart mantras and dhāraṇīs that arise from the Rite of the Three Pledges, it is the one that accomplishes every rite.

Next, the terrible rite,
Like something filled with vajras,
Cannot be destroyed by nāgas, asuras and rākṣasas,

Nor by the gods of the Thirty-Three.
When it is angered, even Śakra (Indra),
Worshiped by the gods, will tremble.
Never disparaged by any bhūta,
It is the supreme protector.
Just as in the world with its gods
There is no teacher like the Buddha,
By that word of truth
May all people be protected.

tadyathā oṃ bajraprākara bajraprākara bajradaṃṣṭā bhalābahā curu curu paricumabike culutele namo ratnatrayāya namo bajrabhairabasya mahāganapatisya bajraśakti parśu pāśa hastāya bajrakanaka bajrabaiḍūrya alaṅkṛta śarīrāya bajrapāṇiranupālāya tadyathā bhuru bhuru ānayā ānayā mahāganāpati laghu laghu ehi ehi ākrama ākrama śarīraṃ gṛhītaṃ gṛhītaṃ dṛṣṭaṃ dṛṣṭaṃ bā atra biśatu śarīraṃ kiñcarāyasi bidhuna badhana paṭa paṭa kampa kampa raṅga raṅga moda moda dhama dhama bijṛmbha bijṛmbha pūra pūra ghurṇa ghurṇa ābiśa ābiśa śīghra śīghra mahābajrabhairabo ganapatirājñepayati svāhā

As for the rite: to immobilize all enemies and to cut off all sorcery, make a square maṇḍala with cow dung, and with an angry mind recite the mantra seven times over a weapon. If one then plants it in the ground, all sorcery will at once be cut off.

One who wishes to turn back an enemy army should recite it seven times over a staff. If one throws it in that direction, all the enemies will become stupefied.

If one wishes to bring nāgas under control, one should become wrathful and recite it seven times over a vajra. If one then strikes with it, the nāgas will come under control.

One who wishes to avert hail should whirl the vajra, not too forcefully, and recite in a voice neither too quiet nor too loud. Then the nāgas will not send down hail.

One who wishes to protect beer should enchant white mustard seed seven times for the ingredients of the beer, and it will succeed.

For one who wishes to pacify illness: enchant medicine suited to the illness, or water, seven times. If one drinks it or applies it, one will be freed from the

illness.

For whatever rite one performs, if one recites it seven times, what one intended will be accomplished.

The dhāraṇī called Noble Vajrabhairava, which repels the malevolent, is complete.

Though the dhāraṇīs spoken by the noble ones are of many kinds,
This dhāraṇī spoken from the mouth of Vajrabhairava,
This supreme dhāraṇī endowed with the seven rites of protection,
Is not shared by all: it is the dhāraṇī of sublime yoga.

It was translated by the great lord of yogins, Amoghavajra, and bestowed upon the Tibetan bandé Kyo Öjung.

Translator's Notes

• In the nāga rite the text reads "glu" ("songs"), which is evidently a slip for "klu" ("nāgas"); it is translated as "nāgas." The beer-protection sentence is terse. It most likely means enchanting mustard seed on behalf of the brewing ingredients, though it could also mean enchanting both the ingredients and the mustard seed. In the hail rite, "ha cang gsang mi mtho bar" is read as "neither too quiet (gsang) nor too loud (mtho)."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.